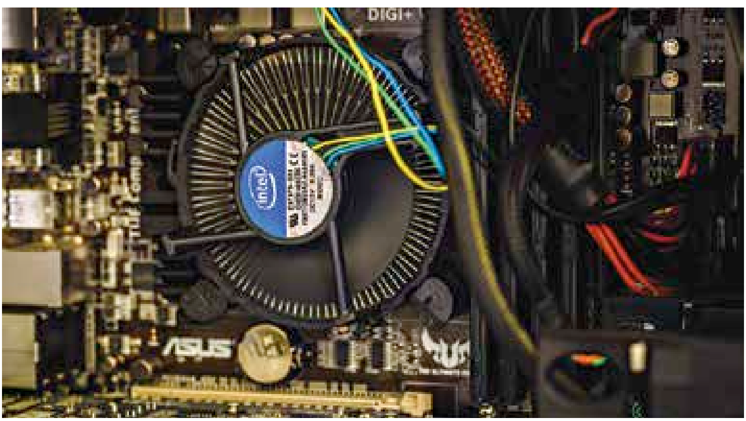
it. It'll have a black socket cover, don't try to remove this. Unpack your processor and orient the golden triangle on one of it's corners with the imprinted triangle on one of the socket edges and the notches on the side of the chip with the socket. Very gently place the processor in the socket (seriously, doesn't matter if you have a Land Grid Array or an LGA chip [i.e, your motherboard socket has the pins and your chip has bumps] or a Pin Grid array or PGA chip [i.e, your motherboard has holes and your chip has the pins]. DO NOT USE FORCE WHEN DROPPING THE CHIP INTO PLACE). Bring the locking arm down and engage it. The black cover should pop right off and you should hear a solid thunk signifying the CPU is seated correctly.

Installing a cooler: Even though your cooling hardware might be different (you might go for an aftermarket cooler or maybe AIO/Custom Water Cooling), mounting them is similar. For Intel processors, the stock coolers will come with push pins. Just align them with the sockets around the CPU and push them with a good amount of force until you hear a satisfying click (We can confirm. It's extremely satisfying). For AMD processors, you'll have to screw the cooler into those sockets instead of pushing. Both are pretty easy to mount. Stock coolers have the Thermal Interface Material or TIM preapplied. If you are going for an aftermarket cooler or want a different one for some reason, clean the chip and the cooler with 90% isopropyl alcohol and squeeze a pea sized amount of a TIM of your choice in the centre of the processor and install the cooler over it. The pressure and the heat once the computer starts working will spread the TIM in a nice thin layer that



Beating the heat